Iteration L2: Deployment to the Cloud

Deploying to production isn't hard at all; it's just a number of small steps. And these steps will go quicker if you do them in the correct order and start with a code base that you've deployed locally first. But first, let's review what resources are available:

- kamal-deploy.org[92] contains a 32-minute video demonstrating the creation and deployment of a simple application to a Hetzner server.
- Kamal docs[93] contains some reference material that may be useful.
- *Kamal Handbook: The Missing Manual*[94] is a short and practical book and, at the time of this writing, the only book on the subject.

What follows is neither a video nor a manual, but rather a recipe. And like most recipes, it starts with assembling your ingredients. Along the way, we will share some general ideas of what prices you can expect to pay for each. We'll also list a number of popular choices. These lists are neither endorsements nor meant to be exhaustive.

We're going to start with a single machine, running Sqlite3. Later, in *Horizontal Scaling*, we'll outline the steps you need to take to scale to multiple machines, running PostgreSQL or another database.

Assemble Your Ingredients

While in theory you can assemble ingredients in any order, things might go faster if you do them in the order shown. Think of this as a scavenger hunt, where sometimes the item you pick up is needed for your next clue.

SSH Key

SSH keys are used to authenticate you to a server. You can think of them as a password that you don't have to remember.